

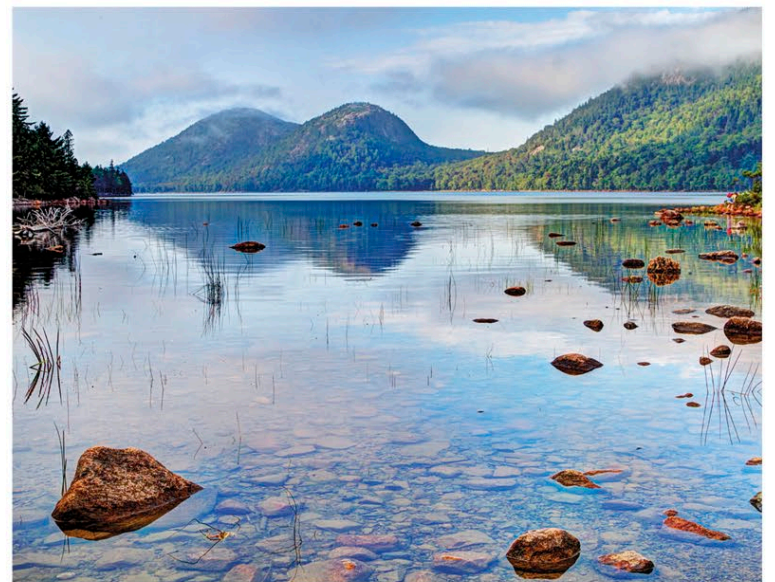


Acadia Coastline

An area of rugged coastal scenery, interspersed with tranquil inlets and harbors

Forming part of the coast of Maine, Acadia National Park consists principally of one large island, Mount Desert Island, and several smaller islands nearby. It is best known for its distinctive rocky coastline—the result of a complex series of geological processes over hundreds of millions of years. These include the intrusion of magma into existing sedimentary rock layers about 360 million years ago to form granite masses. From about 2 million years ago, a huge ice-sheet blanketed the area and sculpted out a series of mountains separated by U-shaped valleys. Today, waves and tides are major agents of change at Acadia, gradually eroding cliffs and depositing the debris as sediments around the coastline.

The **base rocks** of the Acadia coastline are up to **500 million years old**



△ SHELTERED INLET

In some areas, wave-pounded cliffs give way to tranquil inlets. Sea-level rise since the last ice age has resulted in the flooding of these glacier-sculpted valleys.



△ MEANDERING CHANNELS

The bay's vast intertidal zone (the area covered at high tide and exposed at low tide) has a web of deep channels scoured out by tidal currents.

▽ LOW TIDE

At St. Martins, on Fundy's northern shore, it is possible at low tide to "walk the ocean floor" out to sea caves. At high tide, the sea fills the caves.

